

The Personal Robot: The Next Technological Revolution?

June 2026

Insert the appropriate words into the text from the choices below.

Score 0 / 12

In the late 1970s, the personal computer was regarded by many as an expensive **1)** kink with limited practical applications. Few people could have predicted that within a few decades it would become an indispensable part of daily life, transforming communication, education, entertainment, healthcare, and business. Today, personal robots appear to be at a similar stage of development. Although they remain relatively uncommon and expensive, many experts believe they could become as **2)** ubiquitous in the twenty-first century as personal computers became in the twentieth.

A personal robot would be far more than a machine that performs simple **3)** chores around the home. Advances in artificial intelligence, robotics, sensors, and energy storage may allow future robots to function as companions, assistants, tutors, carers, and even collaborators. By the year 2100, it is conceivable that every **4)** household could possess one or more highly sophisticated robots capable of understanding human emotions, anticipating needs, and carrying out complex tasks with minimal supervision.

The impact on family life could be profound. Robots might **5)** undertake cooking, cleaning, maintenance, shopping, and childcare duties, freeing people from routine responsibilities. In entertainment, they could organise personalised activities, participate in games, or create immersive virtual experiences tailored to individual preferences. Perhaps most significantly, personal robots could revolutionise care for elderly or disabled individuals. As populations age across much of the world, robots could provide round-the-clock assistance, monitor health conditions, administer medication, and offer **6)** companionship to those at risk of social isolation.

However, such a future would not be without its **7)** drawbacks. One concern is the potential erosion of human skills. If robots perform most domestic and administrative tasks, future generations may become increasingly dependent on technology. There is also the risk of reduced human interaction. Elderly people, children, or vulnerable individuals might receive efficient care from robots but experience less **8)** deep contact with family members or communities.

We should also **9)** gasp the economic consequences. While personal robots would create new industries and professions, they could simultaneously eliminate millions of jobs in services, transport, healthcare support, and administration. Managing this transition fairly would represent one of the greatest challenges facing governments.

Consequently, regulation will play a crucial role. Legislators may need to establish strict standards governing privacy, data collection, liability, and decision-making authority. Questions surrounding robot rights, **10)** accountability for accidents, and the ethical use of artificial intelligence could become central political issues by the end of the century.

Ultimately, the personal robot may prove to be as transformative as the personal computer was a century earlier. If managed **11)** wisely, it could enhance quality of life, increase productivity, and support an ageing population. If managed poorly, it could deepen inequality, weaken social bonds, and create unprecedented ethical dilemmas. Humanity's challenge will be **12)** ensuring that these remarkable machines remain tools that serve people rather than technologies that reshape society in undesirable ways.

1. A) kink	B) outflow	C) odyssey	D) oddity
2. A) unique	B) ubiquitous	C) all-seeing	D) well-versed
3. A) chores	B) appointments	C) errands	D) missions
4. A) door	B) household	C) housing	D) threshold
5. A) undergo	B) undermake	C) undertake	D) overtake
6. A) shipmate	B) companionship	C) pairing	D) mating
7. A) kickbacks	B) backups	C) drawbacks	D) holdups
8. A) deep	B) pointing	C) meaningless	D) meaningful
9. A) gasp	B) grip	C) null	D) mull
10. A) retaking	B) accountability	C) accounting	D) resigning
11. A) proudly	B) clumsily	C) wisely	D) inanely
12) A) undergoing	B) ensuring	C) remarking	D) insuring



The Personal Robot

Questions

Indicate the appropriate answer from the questions below.

1 - In the first paragraph, the writer suggests ...
a) ... people thought PCs were strange.
b) ... people didn't like PCs.
c) ... people underestimated how useful PCs would become.
d) ... PCs became popular very quickly.

2 - In paragraph 2, the writer suggests ...
a) ... that robots will be very expensive.
b) ... that robots will replace friends.
c) ... that robots will take over the world.
d) ... that robots could become part of everyday life.

3 - In paragraph 3, the writer suggests ...
a) .... that robots would replace people.
b) .... that robots could be indispensible in looking after people.
c) .... that robots might make life difficult for vulnerable people.
d) .... that robots would supervise every aspect of human life.

4 - In the fourth paragraph, the writer suggests ...
a) ... that there are some disadvantages to having robots in every home.
b) .... that robots cannot do everything.
c) .... that people will exploit robots or abuse them.
d) .... that people will become lazy.

5 - In paragraph 5, the writer suggests ...
a) .... that nobody would have any money in the future.
b) .... that this kind of future could change the world's economy.
c) .... that robots would have to run the economy as well.
d) .... that only robots would work in the future.

6 - In paragraph 6, the writer suggests ...
a) ... that the law would need to take robots into account.
b) .... that robots could replace the police force.
c) .... that robots could begin to run countries.
d) .... that robot criminals could be a big problem.

7 - In paragraph 7, the writer suggests ...
a) .... that a future with robots is inevitable.
b) .... that a future with robots is going to be fun.
c) ... that a future with robots is a matter to be taken seriously.
d) .... that a future with robots is nothing to worry about.





Robot Care

Watch the **YouTube video** and answer the following questions.

Who are Luna, Zak, and Chiyong, and what are their tasks for the evening?
How many people born today will live to be over 100 years old?
What has happened to the population of over-60s since 1980?
What could a day with robot carers be like in the future according to the presenter?
What would the logistical aspects of this kind of future entail?
What are the legal implications?

Click link below to watch on YouTube
https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=WGb0TdIQR2M

Vocabulary

Quiz Night = A general knowledge competition for entertainment.
Care home = A residential home that looks after very old people.
Carers = People who look after other people.
Exoskeleton = A device for helping disabled people move around.
Unburdened = To be free of something.
Sumptuous = Luxurious or delicious.
Hazard = Danger.

Will we have robots at home?

Would you like to have a personal robot in the house that could do the same tasks as a human? Maybe, probably not

Should a humanoid robot have rights? Depends on AI independence, still kinda sci-fi

Could robots become dangerous to humans? They already are

Would you trust a humanoid doctor? Maybe

Would you trust a robot to cook your food? Maybe, somateimes

Would you trust a robot to look after a baby? No



Could robots ever be cheap enough for every household? Almost certainly not.

What kinds of tasks would you never want a robot to do? Depends on the type and kind of robot and the implementation, but definiately childcare

Do you think robots would make family life better or worse? There is potential for both at the same time

How might robots change the way people form relationships? They might help improve communication skils and physical conditions, skills

Who should be responsible if a robot makes a serious mistake? Legally if the person made a mistake it's responsible, if the robot, then it's the robot or the manufacturing company

Would you prefer a robot assistant or a human carer in old age? Hopefully none

Could relying on robots make people lazier or less capable over time? Yes

Do you think emotional attachment to robots is healthy or dangerous? Dangerous



In what areas (healthcare, education, childcare) would robots be most useful? Automation, or where the machine's capabilities over exceed the human's and it's help improves the outcome

Will robots reduce loneliness or increase it in society? Might do both, but probably loneliness

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